

Deserae Mendoza

deseraemendoza857@gmail.com | (213) 362-8276 | Github: Deseraee | LinkedIn: Deseraee

Education

University of California Santa Barbara,
Bachelor of Science in **Computer Science**

Expected : June 2028

Skills

AI tools: Claude AI, Copilot, Gemini AI, Anthropic AI

Programming Languages: C++, Swift, Javascript, HTML, Python

Frameworks: React JS, ReactNative, Django

Developer Tools: Github, Linux, Visual Studio Code, PyCharm, LaTeX, Google Colab

Experiences

Full Stack Intern, Sponsors for Educational Opportunity - Tech Developer

May 2026 - Present

- Worked on a cross-functional team to build a full stack project from ideation to delivery, using daily stand-ups and group presentations to align on features and sprint goals.
- Strengthened DSA and full-stack development through hands-on coding, 1:1 engineering manager check-ins, and mock technical interviews focused on real-world engineering problems.

Research Assistant, UCSB Early Research Scholar Program

September 2025 - Present

- Pioneered mastery-based learning transformation by replacing high-stakes exams with frequent, low-stakes assessments using PrairieLearn—accelerating student concept mastery and long-term retention.
- Conducted comparative data analysis of student performance metrics pre- and post-PrairieLearn implementation to quantify improvements in learning outcomes and conceptual proficiency.

Full Stack Engineer, Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers Innovation Program R2

August 2025 - October 2025

- Engineered a market-ready prototype for a community-based alert system, integrating social features from concept to functional product.
- Developed and deployed a full-stack mobile application utilizing **React Native** for the frontend and **Django** for the backend, applying product design and development principles under the guidance of an HP engineer mentor.

Software Developer Apprenticeship, Girls Who Code and Athenahealth

May 2025 - June 2025

- Immersed in GWC's three-week career exploration program, gaining insights from workshops on Social Determinants of Health, diverse healthcare careers, and effective collaboration strategies.
- Collaborated with a team of four to engineer an athenahealth prototype that addresses non-medical factors (SDoH) impacting patient health, aimed at improving patient service and healthcare quality using **Figma** for visual design.

Projects

Frontend Engineer, SEO Tech Developer

July 2026

- Collaborated with a team to engineer Empowering Her, a safety web application for women, utilizing **React**, **Node.js**, **JavaScript**, and **Firebase** to create an integrated platform for emergency alerts and resource access.
- Researched outdoor safety pain points for novice hikers, identifying gaps in real-time plant/animal identification and navigation that contribute to disorientation and hazard exposure in unfamiliar terrain

Backend Developer, SEO Tech Developer

June 2026

- Developed a hiking safety app addressing the lack of real-time plant/animal identification for novice hikers, a key factor in trail disorientation and hazard exposure.
- Architected the full stack using **React** (frontend), **Flask** (backend/API routing), and **SQLite** (local data storage), integrating the **Claude AI** API and National Parks Service API, and validated functionality with a 6-test unit test suite

Leadership

Internal Committee, SHPE UC Santa Barbara Los Ingenieros

October 2024 - Present

- Organized and prepared for MESA Day competitions, mentoring students in STEM through hands-on projects while facilitating academic workshops on public speaking, research, and professional development.